



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Holy Trinity Academy - Lower School
School Website: <https://www.holytrinityacademy.org/>

December 22, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

Holy Trinity Academy Lower School (Schriever, LA, 70395) presents a robust classical-Catholic program that aligns strongly with the Six Essential Elements framework. Public materials describe it as a Classical School in the Catholic Tradition, with a clear emphasis on formation, virtue, and the pursuit of truth, goodness, and beauty. The public-facing content consistently foregrounds Catholic formation, a classical liberal-arts curriculum, the Great Books/Great Conversation ethos, and pedagogies such as Socratic dialogue, disciplined memory work, and a memorializing, liturgical rhythm. Evidence also highlights the school's intentional partnerships with parents and a communal, incarnational approach to education. Taken as a whole, the school demonstrates a predominantly CLASSICAL orientation across all six categories.

Key signals across categories include: the Catholic groundings (Magisterium, daily Mass, Incarnation), the classical curriculum (grammar–logic–rhetoric, liberal arts, Great Books discussions, Socratic pedagogy), the focus on formation and virtue (pillar of formation, formation plan, virtue-centered aims), the living faculty as mentors and models, and strong parent/community engagement (parent formation, open campus, family involvement). The site explicitly notes the Pillars of Formation (Spiritual, Intellectual, Human), emphasizes the Magisterium, and presents a robust classical curriculum with a strong communal and liturgical character. Notable textual anchors include phrases such as "A Classical School in the Catholic Tradition," "pursue truth, goodness, and beauty," "daily Mass," "Pillars of Formation," "An Incarnational Environment," and "The Humanities Program ... utilizing the Socratic Method." These are all consistent with a Classical framework, not merely a subset, and there is little to no material in the public-facing materials suggesting a move away from classical aims.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The site identifies Holy Trinity Academy as "A Classical School in the Catholic Tradition" and emphasizes Catholic formation at the center of mission (daily Mass, Magisterium, Jesus Christ at the center).
- An Incarnational Environment and explicit focus on Truth, Goodness, and Beauty appear in the public materials (Incarnation as central to the curriculum; Pillars of Formation include Spiritual, Intellectual, and Human).

- Mission language highlights formation in a Catholic context, including references to Magisterium fidelity and virtue formation.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: truth, goodness, beauty; virtue; theology; liturgy; Mass; Incarnation; Magisterium; sacred; reverence; wonder; imago Dei; logos; wisdom; prudence; justice; fortitude. The site repeatedly nudges toward these concepts (e.g., "pursue truth, goodness, and beauty"; daily Mass; Magisterium).

- Negative keywords: none evident in public content (no relativism, secular-humanist or values-clarification signals detected in public-facing materials). Positive predominates.

Why this rating - The public materials foreground a Catholic, theologically-informed, incarnational foundation and liturgical/communal life, which map directly onto the Positive keyword indicators for category 1. The

absence of negative signals further strengthens CLASSICAL labeling.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The program emphasizes formation, virtue, and human flourishing rather than vocational training. The mission statements and pillars stress formation in virtue and the pursuit of the true, good, and beautiful. The content discusses helping parents form the next generation of faithful Catholics and articulate the purpose of education beyond career prep. - Public materials articulate a classical objective: liberal education, formation, and the cultivation of wisdom and virtue. The text repeatedly frames education as formation toward human excellence and virtue, not just information delivery.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: formation; virtue; human flourishing; liberal education; paideia; classical mission; telos; scholé; Great Conversation; human excellence; wisdom. The site's language around formation and virtue aligns well with these indicators. - Negative keywords: minimal to none (no explicit focus on workforce-prep language or 21st-century-skill framing in the mission statements).

Why this rating - The school's stated purposes center on formation, virtue, and enduring human excellence rather than job-ready metrics, aligning with CLASSICAL expectations for purpose and telos.

Element 3: Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The curriculum is framed around liberal arts and the Trivium and Quadrivium in public materials and related content; there is explicit reference to a liberal arts foundation and classical curriculum. The Humanities Program emphasizes history, literature, philosophy, theology, and languages with a Socratic Method. There are direct mentions of Great Books and prominent Catholic thinkers in the broader public materials. - The school presents Great Books/Great Conversation lineage (Socrates, Aquinas, Dante) and a cross-disciplinary integration of humanities with theology and classical thought. This is reinforced by references to Socratic pedagogy and the integrated curriculum. □filecite□turn10□ - Historical/cultural depth is emphasized (history as salvation history; Western civilization; sacred arts within curriculum).

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: liberal arts; trivium; quadrivium; grammar; logic; rhetoric; great books; primary sources; classics; history; Western civilization; Socratic texts; recitation; narration; dictation; sacred art; chant. The materials frequently cite the classical curriculum vocabulary and Great Books orientation.

- Negative keywords: potential signals in the lexicon (e.g., project-based learning dominance) are not evidenced in the public-facing curriculum descriptions. The site emphasizes traditional memory-work and Socratic methods rather than unstructured project-based dominance.

Why this rating - The explicit emphasis on liberal arts, Trivium/Quadrivium, Great Books, and Socratic pedagogy signals a CLASSICAL curriculum orientation rather than a secular or purely skills-based approach.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Upper-level pedagogy references include Socratic discussion, seminars, rhetorical training, and opportunities for students to give speeches. The Humanities Program explicitly uses the Socratic Method and integrates rhetoric and classical discussion. Lower/Incarnational elements point to contemplative/restful rhythm alongside rigorous study. - The lower-school materials emphasize wonder, memory, and a joyful approach, including chant and singing as part of a restful/formation-based pedagogy. This is consistent with scholé and memory-work traditions. - The curriculum references "The Socratic Seminar" as a key method and the integration of classical rhetoric and public speaking, which aligns with classical pedagogy expectations.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: Socratic seminar; dialectic; great conversation; thoughtful discussion; memory work; recitation; chanting; restfulness (scholé); contemplation; rhetoric; public speaking; master-teacher model; living curriculum. - Negative keywords: any modern,

student-led, project-based-only pedagogy signals are not dominant in public-facing materials; there is clear emphasis on traditional, memory-based and dialogic forms of teaching rather than purely constructivist approaches.

Why this rating - The combination of Socratic/seminar-based upper-school pedagogy with memory work and contemplative/restful elements supports a CLASSICAL pedagogy, reinforced by the explicit mention of scholé and the Great Books/Socratic framework.

Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The site features a Headmaster and executive director with biographies and a strong emphasis on teachers as master educators and virtuous role models. The faculty are described as living curriculum and as mentors, with a strong sense of shared purpose and formation. - Public materials emphasize faculty as master teachers and faithful role models, with a focus on formation and virtuous exemplars. The content also notes faculty involvement in daily Mass and spiritual leadership (see faculty expectations in job postings). - The school highlights the connection between faculty and students as a “portrait of what a teacher should be” and “living curriculum,” consistent with classical pedagogy norms.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: master teachers; mentors; living curriculum; portrait of a teacher; faculty as exemplars; moral formation; collegial culture; formation of teachers. - Negative keywords: none evident in public-facing materials; no signals of superficial or de-emphasizing teacher-centered classical formation.

Why this rating - The materials present a faculty culture that embodies classical expectations: virtuous exemplars, master-teacher role models, and a living-curriculum approach.

Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The public materials repeatedly emphasize partnership with parents and the role of parents as co-teachers, with ongoing parent formation (e.g., Arete/Scholarship contexts, parent education). Open campus access and invitations to events reflect a welcoming, formation-focused community model. - The school explicitly notes “Supporting Parents as Primary Educators” and invites families to engage through open houses, book clubs, and community gatherings. Regulatory/evangelical language around parent involvement is frequent in the content. - The school markets events (Open House) and opportunities (Arete Scholars, formation events) that actively involve parents and the broader community in classical formation.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: partnership with parents; co-teachers; parent formation; classical book clubs; open campus; family liturgy; hospitality; parent covenant. - Negative keywords: no signals of a consumer-only approach; not a few general “customer” touches; rather, a formation-oriented parental role is foregrounded.

Why this rating - The school's public messaging consistently treats parents as co-educators and emphasizes parent formation and engagement, which aligns with CLASSICAL expectations for category 6.

Overall Category Aggregation and Classification

- All six categories render CLASSICAL. The aggregate profile suggests a fully CLASSICAL orientation rather than SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL or NOT CLASSICAL.

What would move the needle

- Not applicable here given CLASSICAL consensus across all six categories. If a needle move were desired, it might focus on further codifying and publicly publishing explicit Great Books lists and sample lesson sequences to strengthen transparency around the Great Conversation and the Trivium/Quadrivium integration. However, as it stands, the school already demonstrates full CLASSICAL alignment across the six essential elements.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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